tween the Lake Huron Lightship and the southerly limit of the improved channels of the Detroit River, terminating in Lake Erie, the length of towlines shall not exceed by more than 50 feet the length of the scow, barge, vessel, or other craft being towed: *Provided*, that no scow, barge, vessel, or other craft shall be required to have a towline less than 250 feet. The length of the towline shall be measured from the stern of one vessel to the bow of the following vessel.

[Regs. Feb. 28, 1948, CE–ENGWR] (40 Stat. 266, 892; 33 U. S. C. 1, 3)

[SEAL] EDWARD F. WITSELL,
Major General,
The Adjutant General.

[F. R. Doc. 48-2015; Filed, Mar. 5, 1948; 8:56 a. m.]

TITLE 43—PUBLIC LANDS: INTERIOR

Subtitle A—Office of the Secretary of the Interior

[Order 2409]

PART 4—DELEGATIONS OF AUTHORITY

FISH AND WILDLIFE SERVICE

Section 4.561 is added to Part 4 to read as follows:

§ 4.561 *Delegation to Director and Assistant Directors.* The Director and the Assistant Directors of the Fish and Wildlife Service are each authorized to enter into agreements for the acquisition of lands or of interests in land whenever such lands or interests in land are to be acquired for administration through the Fish and Wildlife Service pursuant to any act of Congress. (Sec. 3, 60 Stat. 238; 5 U. S. C. Sup. 1002)

Departmental Order No. 2087 of August 21, 1945 (unpublished), is superseded.

Issued this 26th day of February 1948.

OSCAR L. CHAPMAN,
Acting Secretary of the Interior.

[F. R. Doc. 48-1995; Filed, Mar. 5, 1948; 8:59 a. m.]

Chapter I—Bureau of Land Management, Department of the Interior

Appendix—Public Land Orders

[Public Land Order 449]

NEW MEXICO

REVOKING IN PART EXECUTIVE ORDER NO. 9109 OF MARCH 21, 1942, AS AMENDED WITHDRAWING PUBLIC LANDS FOR USE OF WAR DEPARTMENT FOR MILITARY PURPOSES

By virtue of the authority vested in the President and pursuant to Executive Order No. 9337 of April 24, 1943, it is ordered as follows:

Executive Order No. 9109 of March 21, 1942, as amended by Executive Order No. 9526 of February 28, 1945, withdrawing public lands for the use of the War Department for military purposes, is hereby revoked so far as it affects the hereinafter-described lands.

The jurisdiction over and use of such lands granted to the War Department by Executive Order No. 9109 shall cease upon the date of the signing of this order. Thereupon, the jurisdiction over and administration of such lands shall be vested in the Department of the Interior and any other Department or agency of the Federal Government, according to their respective interests then of record.

This order shall not otherwise become effective to change the status of such lands until 10:00 a. m. on April 30, 1948. At that time the lands shall, subject to valid existing rights and the provisions of existing withdrawals, become subject to application, petition, location, or selection as follows:

(a) *Ninety-day period for preference-right filings.* For a period of 90 days from April 30, 1948, to July 30, 1948, inclusive, the public lands affected by this order shall be subject to (1) application under the homestead or the desert land laws, or the small tract act of June 1, 1938 (52 Stat. 609, 43 U. S. C. 682a), as amended, by qualified veterans of World War II, for whose service recognition is granted by the act of September 27, 1944 (58 Stat. 747, 43 U. S. C. Sup. 279–283), subject to the requirements of applicable law, and (2) application under any applicable public-land law, based on prior existing valid settlement rights and preference rights conferred by existing laws or equitable claims subject to allowance and confirmation. Applications by such veterans shall be subject to claims of the classes described in subdivision (2).

(b) *Twenty-day advance period for simultaneous preference-right filings.* For a period of 20 days from April 10, 1948, to April 30, 1948, inclusive, such veterans and persons claiming preference rights superior to those of such veterans, may present their applications, and all such applications, together with those presented at 10:00 a. m. on April 30, 1948, shall be treated as simultaneously filed.

(c) *Date for non-preference-right filings authorized by the public-land laws.* Commencing at 10:00 a. m. on July 31, 1948, any of the lands remaining unappropriated shall become subject to such application, petition, location, or selection by the public generally as may be authorized by the public-land laws.

(d) *Twenty-day advance period for simultaneous non-preference-right filings.* Applications by the general public may be presented during the 20-day period from July 12, 1948, to July 31, 1948, inclusive, and all such applications, together with those presented at 10:00 a. m. on July 31, 1948, shall be treated as simultaneously filed.

Veterans shall accompany their applications with certified copies of their certificates of discharge, or other satisfactory evidence of their military or naval service. Persons asserting preference rights, through settlement or otherwise, and those having equitable claims, shall accompany their applications by duly corroborated affidavits in support thereof, setting forth in detail all facts relevant to their claims.

Applications for these lands, which shall be filed in the District Land Office, Las Cruces, New Mexico, shall be acted upon in accordance with the regulations contained in § 295.8 of Title 43 of the Code of Federal Regulations (Circular No. 324, May 22, 1914, 43 L. D. 254), and Part 296 of that title, to the extent that such regulations are applicable. Applications under the homestead laws shall be governed by the regulations contained in Parts 166 to 170, inclusive, of Title 43 of the Code of Federal Regulations and applications under the desert land laws and the small tract act of June 1, 1938, shall be governed by the regulations contained in Parts 232 and 257, respectively, of that title.

Inquiries concerning these lands shall be addressed to the District Land Office, Las Cruces, New Mexico.

The lands affected by this order are described as follows:

NEW MEXICO PRINCIPAL MERIDIAN

T. 23 S., R. 18 W.,
Sec. 12;
Sec. 13, E½ and SW¼.

The areas described aggregate 1,120 acres.

The land varies from level to rolling, rough and rocky arid desert.

C. GIRARD DAVIDSON,
Assistant Secretary of the Interior.

FEBRUARY 27, 1948.

[F. R. Doc. 48-1996; Filed, Mar. 5, 1948; 8:47 a. m.]

[Public Land Order 450]

NEW MEXICO

REVOKING PUBLIC LAND ORDER NO. 55 OF NOVEMBER 5, 1942, WITHDRAWING PUBLIC LANDS FOR USE OF WAR DEPARTMENT AS PRACTICE BOMBING RANGES

By virtue of the authority vested in the President and pursuant to Executive Order No. 9337 of April 24, 1943, it is ordered as follows:

Public Land Order No. 55 of November 5, 1942, withdrawing the hereinafter-described lands for use of the War Department as practice bombing ranges is hereby revoked.

The jurisdiction over and use of such lands granted to the War Department by Public Land Order No. 55 shall cease upon the date of signing of this order. Thereupon, the jurisdiction over and administration of such lands shall be vested in the Department of the Interior and any other Department or agency of the Federal Government according to their respective interest then of record.

This order shall not otherwise become effective to change the status of such lands until 10:00 a. m. on April 30, 1948. At that time the lands shall, subject to valid existing rights and the provisions of existing withdrawals, become subject to application, petition, location, or selection as follows:

(a) *Ninety-day period for preference-right filings.* For a period of 90 days from April 30, 1948, to July 30, 1948, inclusive, the public lands affected by this order shall be subject to (1) application under the homestead or the desert land laws, or the small tract act of June 1, 1938 (52 Stat. 609, 43 U. S. C. 682a), as amended, by qualified veterans of World